

"YES, I AM THE REMOTE CONTROL. WE NEED IT."



ASHESH SHAH

Bal Thackeray

Hindutva rode to power in Maharashtra as Shiv Sena and the BJP formed a coalition government. The man behind it all was Balasaheb Thackeray, forever enshrined in Salman Rushdie's words as Raman Fielding aka Mainduck, who wanted a golden age when "good Hindu men and women could roam free". He ran the government by remote control and things began to change soon enough, with Bombay becoming Mumbai and the media subjected to cultural censorship.

COLOURFUL MOVES

For Urmila Matondkar, *Rangeela* was a case of real becoming reel and vice versa. A.R. Rahman's slick soundtrack, Manish Malhotra's new fashion sense, and Matondkar's moves enthralled audiences as she announced herself to the world. She had found her makeover mantra and as a spate of copycats, flouncing peroxide curls and lycra twirls prowled the screens, Bollywood found a new definition of cool.



SHAH RUKH KHAN about competition in the Mumbai film industry

"In my opinion... I am the best."

And the World Went Dark

A complete solar eclipse was seen over India on October 24 and was visible from Rajasthan to West Bengal. Some hailed the spectacle of astronomy, others hid away in superstition. The last total eclipse was in 1980.



BHAWAN SINGH

● 168 people, including eight federal marshals and 19 children, were killed at the Murrah Federal Building in the Oklahoma City bombing. Timothy McVeigh and one of his accom-



plices, Terry Nichols, set off the bomb.

● Members of the Aum Shinrikyo religious cult released sarin nerve gas on five separate railway trains in Tokyo, killing 12 and injuring hundreds. Cult leader Shoko Asahara was arrested May 16.

● For the first time in 26 years, British soldiers stayed off the streets of Belfast, Northern Ireland.

Rs 1,500

crore was the estimated market worth of the exquisite jewels of the seventh Nizam of Hyderabad. After a protracted battle, the Indian Government finally acquired them for a paltry sum of Rs 218 crore.